Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2 (modified)

Poinsettias



TODAY'S PLAN

- 🌺 History and bracts
- 🌙 Photoperiod
- 💧 Care chart and problems
- 🛒 Sale and portfolio

Review · 5 minutes

Quick Review



✂️ Sexual vs. asexual propagation?

🎋 Where do you cut a stem cutting?

🧪 Two rules for rooting hormone?

Words to Know

Words to Know



Poinsettia

A plant from Mexico grown for its colorful bracts and sold in November and December.



Bract

The colored leaf-like part of a poinsettia. It looks like a petal but is a modified leaf.



Cyathia

The small yellow true flowers in the center of the bracts.



Short days

Poinsettias need long, totally dark nights (about 14 hours) to change color.

Words to Know

More Words to Know



⏰ **Photoperiod**: The length of daylight. It controls when some plants bloom or color.

🦟 **Whitefly**: A common poinsettia pest: tiny white insects under the leaves.

🍄 **Botrytis**: A fungus disease (gray mold) that grows when leaves stay wet.

🧤 **Sap**: Poinsettia sap is milky and can irritate skin and eyes. Latex allergy risk: wear nitrile gloves.

Learn

Poinsettia Basics



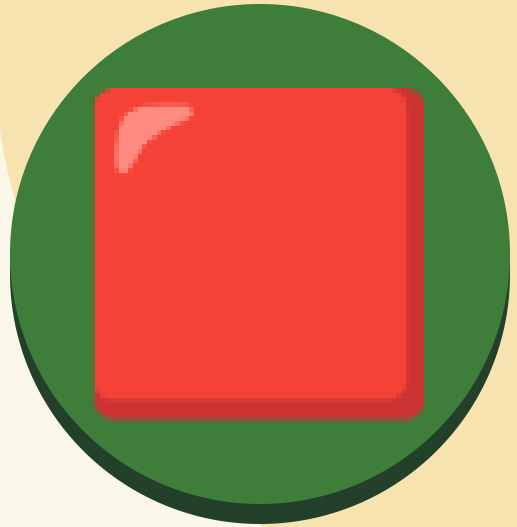
Native to **Mexico**; named for Joel Poinsett, who brought it to the US in the 1820s.

The #1 potted flowering plant sold in the US, mostly in November–December.

Growers start them from **cuttings** in summer.

Compare

Bracts vs. Flowers



🟥

Bracts

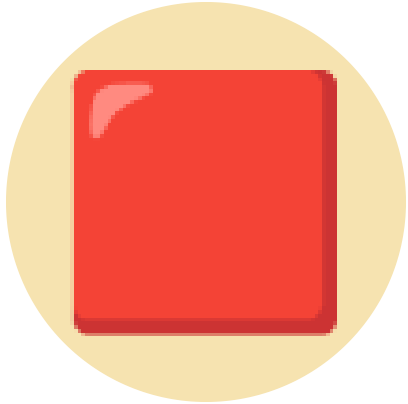
Colored modified leaves
red, white, pink, marbled

🟡

Cyathia

Tiny yellow true flowers
fresh = pollen not shed

🃏 Check 1 of 3



Poinsettias get their color in the…

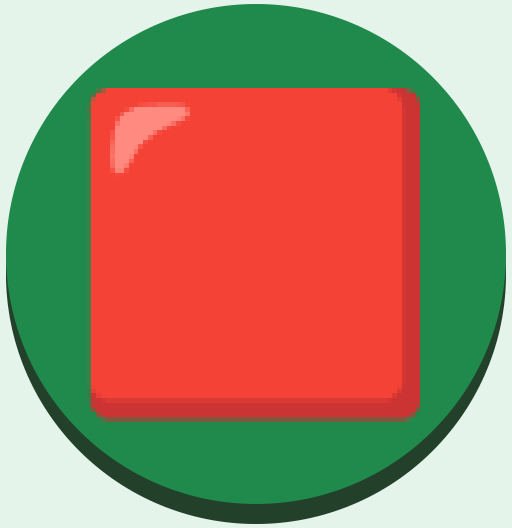
Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Flowers

2️⃣ Bracts

3️⃣ Roots

✅ Answer · Card 1 of 3



Bracts

Bracts are modified leaves.

Learn

Photoperiod: Short Days



Poinsettias are **short-day plants**: they color when nights are long.

They need about **14 hours of total darkness** each night from early October.

Even a street light or a flashlight can stop coloring.

🃏 Check 2 of 3



A poinsettia under a street light all night will…

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Turn red faster

2️⃣ Make seeds

3️⃣ Stay green

✅ Answer · Card 2 of 3



Stay green

Light breaks the dark period.

Learn

Care Chart



Water

when soil surface is dry; water the soil



Light

bright, indirect



Temp

60–70°F, no drafts



Log

date, action, observation

Learn

Problems



Whiteflies

tiny white insects under leaves



Mealybugs/mites

cottony spots; fine webbing



Botrytis

gray mold from wet leaves



Root rot

brown roots from overwatering

🃏 Check 3 of 3



Why keep water off poinsettia leaves?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Wet leaves invite botrytis mold

2️⃣ Leaves drink too fast

3️⃣ Water stains the pot

✅ Answer · Card 3 of 3

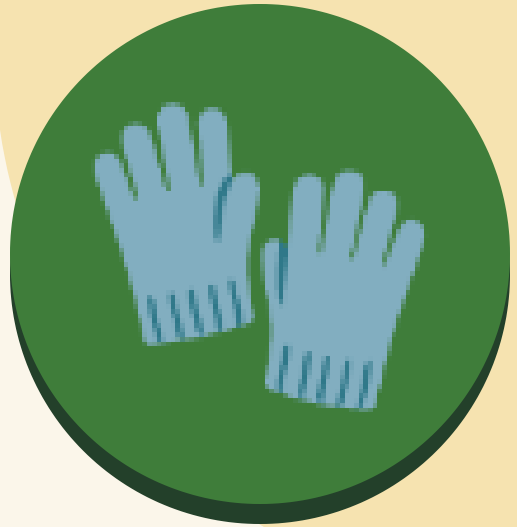


Wet leaves invite botrytis mold

Gray mold.

Learn

Safety



Milky **sap** irritates skin and eyes; poinsettias are related to rubber (latex).

Latex allergy → nitrile gloves or skip handling.

Pesticides and growth regulators are staff only.

Learn

The Sale and Portfolio



FFA Flower Shop sale in December; plants are **sleeved** to protect them from cold.

Portfolio: cover, care chart, flier, thank-you card, order form, lab report.

Count money with a staff partner.

Wrap-Up

Recap



Bracts
color



14 hr dark
to color



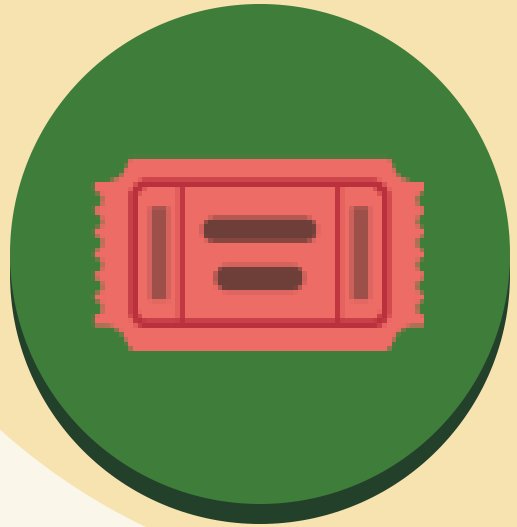
Botrytis
keep leaves dry



Sleeve
protects from cold

Wrap-Up

Exit Ticket



Where does a poinsettia get its color?

What does photoperiod mean for poinsettias?

Name 2 pests or problems and how to prevent one.